

PRINCE2 | P2-11

Plan

Project Plan / Stage Plan / Team Plan / Exception Plan

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Plan
Document reference	P2-11-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project Manager (Team Plans: Team Manager)
Approver	Project Board (Project, Stage and Exception Plans); Project Manager (Team Plans)
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
P2-12	Product Description	One per product in the plan
P2-04	Business Case	Costs and timescales flow to the case
P2-13	Work Package	Derived from the Stage Plan

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Provides a statement of how and when objectives are to be achieved, showing the products, activities, resources, timescales and controls for the level of plan concerned.
Framework	PRINCE2 — Project Plan created in Initiating a Project; Stage Plans at each stage boundary; Team Plans in Managing Product Delivery; Exception Plans when tolerance is forecast to be exceeded
Created when	Per level — see above
Reviewed / updated	Continuously; formally at stage boundaries
Owner	Project Manager (Team Plans: Team Manager)
Approver	Project Board (Project, Stage and Exception Plans); Project Manager (Team Plans)
Format options	Delete the sections that do not apply to the level of plan being produced. Mark clearly at the top which level this is.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It is achievable and those who will carry out the work believe it is
- Estimates are based on stated assumptions and a documented method
- Products, not just activities, are identified — the product breakdown structure drives the schedule
- Dependencies inside and outside the project are shown
- It supports the Business Case and the required tolerances

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1. Plan level and identification

Field	Detail
Plan level	[Project / Stage / Team / Exception]
Covers period	[From — To]
Stage number and name	Tranche 2 — Scale build
Supersedes	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build
Prepared by	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Baseline date	18 Sep 2026

2. Plan description

A brief narrative: what this plan covers, the approach taken, and anything notable about how it was produced.

In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

3. Plan prerequisites

Things that must be in place for the plan to succeed and which are outside the plan's control.

Ref	Prerequisite	Owner	Confirmed by
PP-01	Site capacity study and structural survey for hall B	V. Chandra, Product Management	31 Mar 2027
PP-02	Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review report and lessons register	M. Verity, Head of P3O	23 Apr 2027
PP-03	Prioritised ART backlog with WSJF scores	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	28 May 2027
PP-04	Vendor allocation letter and confirmed delivery schedule	H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	25 Jun 2027

4. External dependencies

Ref	Dependency	Provider	Required by	Status
DEP-001	Utility connection uplift to 6 MVA energised at DXB-1	Facilities (external — utility provider)	30 Nov 2026	Amber
DEP-002	400G leaf-spine fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated in hall A	WS3 Network fabric	15 Dec 2026	Green
DEP-003	Identity platform provides workload	Enterprise Identity	31 Oct 2026	Red

Ref	Dependency	Provider	Required by	Status
	<i>identity federation for cluster service accounts</i>	<i>Programme</i>		
DEP-004	<i>Parallel filesystem storage tier accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained</i>	<i>WS2 Compute and storage hardware</i>	<i>20 Jan 2027</i>	<i>Green</i>
DEP-005	<i>Service operations liquid-cooling runbook and two live drills completed</i>	<i>WS7 Service operations and support</i>	<i>28 Feb 2027</i>	<i>Amber</i>
DEP-006	<i>Chargeback rate card approved by the Programme Board</i>	<i>Finance</i>	<i>24 Sep 2026</i>	<i>Red</i>

5. Planning assumptions

Ref	Assumption	Basis	Impact if invalid
ASM-001	<i>Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates</i>	<i>Vendor allocation letter, Jun 2026</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completion slips by at least one quarter and contract terms are renegotiated</i>
ASM-002	<i>DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade</i>	<i>Site capacity study, May 2026</i>	<i>Tranche 2 capped at 1,024 GPUs and the AUH-2 site is brought forward two quarters</i>
ASM-003	<i>Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover</i>	<i>Business case, Apr 2026</i>	<i>Utilisation benefit of AED 14.2m over five years is not realised in full</i>
ASM-004	<i>Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit</i>	<i>Group data residency policy v4.2</i>	<i>Not applicable — this is a fixed constraint on design</i>
ASM-005	<i>Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift</i>	<i>FM contract review, Jun 2026</i>	<i>Annual run cost increases by approximately AED 780,000</i>
ASM-006	<i>No production change may be made during the Group financial close window, the last five working days of each quarter</i>	<i>Group change policy</i>	<i>Not applicable — planned into the release calendar</i>

6. Lessons incorporated

Lessons from previous projects that have shaped this plan. Reference the Lessons Log.

Lesson source	Lesson	How applied here
<i>Helios Tranche 1</i>	<i>Hardware burn-in took 35 days against a 12-day estimate because firmware verification was performed serially on a single isolated VLAN</i>	<i>Yes — reflected in the Tranche 2 schedule</i>
<i>Helios Tranche 1</i>	<i>The rate card decision was deferred twice</i>	<i>Yes — workshop held 24 Sep 2026</i>

Lesson source	Lesson	How applied here
	<i>because Finance and the business units were consulted sequentially rather than together</i>	
Helios Tranche 1	<i>Engaging vendor performance engineering for two weeks during commissioning lifted all-reduce efficiency from 79% to 84% in the first pass</i>	Yes — included in the Tranche 2 estimate
Helios Tranche 1	<i>A critical finding on cluster API exposure was discovered late because the test was scheduled after build completion</i>	Yes — assurance plan revised

7. Monitoring and control

How progress against this plan will be measured, at what frequency, and against what baselines.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail. Detail is maintained by the Project Manager (Team Plans: Team Manager) and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

8. Budgets

Cost budget

Category	Baseline	Committed	Forecast	Variance
Accelerator hardware	31% average utilisation	No	Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail	Nil
Storage and parallel filesystem	AED 19.4m per year	Yes	Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams	–AED 340,000
Network fabric	11.5 days median	Partially	Carried forward from the Tranche 1 lessons register	+AED 1,120,000
Facilities — power, cooling, structural	84% all-reduce efficiency	Yes	Assured independently by Cordant Assurance	+3.1%
Platform software and licences	23 working days	No	Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026	–6 days

Category	Baseline	Committed	Forecast	Variance
Integration partner services	4 open residency exceptions	Yes	Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site	-1.4%

Change budget

Amount set aside for approved changes, and the authority to draw against it.

Risk budget

Amount set aside for risk responses, and the authority to draw against it.

Time budget and contingency

Any float or contingency held, and who controls it.

9. Tolerances

Dimension	Target	Tolerance (+/-)	Escalate to
Time	90 days	90 days	90 days
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.
Quality	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full
Risk	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO

Dimension	Target	Tolerance (+/-)	Escalate to
	acceptance	acceptance	acceptance
Benefit	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation

10. Product descriptions

List the products in this plan. Full Product Descriptions (P2-12) are attached or held in the configuration repository.

Product ID	Product	Type	Description ref	Owner
Independent security assurance report with findings closed	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Regulatory	Self-service environment provisioning targeting a two-hour request-to-usable time	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Organisational	Service operations readiness for liquid-cooled infrastructure, including leak response	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead
Independent security assurance report with findings closed	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Commercial	Consolidate all AI training workloads onto a shared 2,048-GPU platform in DXB-1 halls A and B	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect
Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Security	Service operations readiness for liquid-cooled infrastructure, including leak response	B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead

11. Product breakdown structure

Insert the hierarchical decomposition of the products to be delivered.

The Programme Board meets monthly, chaired by the Group CTO as Senior Responsible Owner, with the Director of Infrastructure, CISO, Finance Business Partner and the three consuming business unit heads. Delivery workstreams report weekly to the Programme Manager. The Agile Release Train holds PI planning quarterly, with Business Owners drawn from the same board. The P3O provides assurance, reporting standards and the RAID consolidation.

12. Product flow diagram

Insert the diagram showing the sequence and interdependence of product creation.

[Insert diagram] — the current version is held in the solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space, and shows DXB-1 halls A and B, the 400G leaf-spine fabric, the parallel filesystem tier, the orchestration control plane and the three tenant namespaces.

13. Schedule

Milestones

Ref	Milestone	Baseline date	Forecast date	Owner	Status
MS-01	Programme mandate approved and funding released for Tranche 1	12 Mar 2026	12 Mar 2026	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Complete
MS-02	Pilot cluster of 256 GPUs live in DXB-1 hall A	28 Aug 2026	28 Aug 2026	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Complete
MS-03	Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review and Tranche 2 funding gate	18 Sep 2026	18 Sep 2026	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	In progress
MS-04	Hall B structural strengthening complete	15 Dec 2026	15 Dec 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Not started
MS-05	Utility uplift to 6 MVA energised	30 Nov 2026	30 Nov 2026	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Not started
MS-06	Hall A scaled to 1,024 GPUs and accepted	26 Feb 2027	26 Feb 2027	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Not started
MS-07	Platform v1.0 released — scheduling, quota, observability, image supply chain	31 Mar 2027	31 Mar 2027	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Not started
MS-08	Independent security assurance and penetration test passed	23 Apr 2027	23 Apr 2027	L. Haddad, CISO	Not started

Activity schedule

Insert or attach the detailed schedule (Gantt chart or equivalent) showing activities, durations, dependencies and resource assignment.

Resource requirements

Resource / role	Source	Effort required	Period	Confirmed
Platform engineer (SRE)	Recruitment, with contractor bridge	6.0	Oct 2026	4 of 6 filled
Network engineer — fabric	Internal from the network team	2.5	Sep 2026	Filled
Data centre engineer	Internal plus M&E	3.5	PI 4	Filled

Resource / role	Source	Effort required	Period	Confirmed
	<i>contractor</i>			
<i>Security architect</i>	<i>Internal from Group Security</i>	<i>0.8</i>	<i>Q4 2026</i>	<i>Filled</i>
<i>ML platform engineer</i>	<i>Internal conversion from data engineering</i>	<i>3.0</i>	<i>Nov 2026</i>	<i>2 of 3 filled</i>
<i>Storage engineer</i>	<i>Vendor professional services</i>	<i>1.5</i>	<i>Oct 2026</i>	<i>Filled</i>
<i>Business change lead</i>	<i>Internal from Group Change</i>	<i>1.0</i>	<i>Sep 2026</i>	<i>Filled</i>

Requested/assigned resources

Named individuals where known, and any resource risks arising from unconfirmed assignments.

14. Exception Plan specifics

Complete only where this is an Exception Plan. Otherwise delete this section.

Cause of the exception

Summarise the Exception Report that triggered this plan.

Consequences of the deviation

What has changed from the plan being replaced

Effect on the Business Case